🧠 Week 6 Knowledge Check

Stakeholder Alignment & Negotiation

Technical Product Manager Academy

🎯 How This Works

12 questions across the week — stakeholder mapping, managing engagement, communicating trade-offs, AI-augmented prep, and live negotiation.

Commit to an answer **before** the reveal. Retrieval is the point.

❓ Question 1

In the Power × Interest grid, which quadrant is the "dangerous" / surprise-veto quadrant?

A) High power, high interest
B) Low power, high interest
C) High power, low interest
D) Low power, low interest

✅ Answer 1 — C

High power, low interest.

They hand you a "no" at the worst possible time. That's why each one goes on the watch list with a named trigger.

❓ Question 2

The RACI discipline for the five key decisions requires that each decision has:

A) At least two Accountable owners, for redundancy
B) Exactly one Accountable owner
C) One Responsible and no Accountable
D) The TPM as Accountable for every decision

✅ Answer 2 — B

Exactly one Accountable per decision.

If two people are A, neither is. If no one is A, the decision rots.

❓ Question 3 — True / False

The org chart is a good enough starting point — a complete stakeholder map is essentially a copy of it.

❌ Answer 3 — False

Org chart ≠ stakeholder map.

Walk the five circles. Complete lists run 10–18 names — and the usual omissions (compliance, finance) are exactly who blindside you.

❓ Question 4

Of the four engagement principles, which two are the *differentiators* (most TPMs do the other two by quarter 2)?

A) Engage early + engage deliberately
B) Match form to power + bidirectional asks
C) Engage early + bidirectional asks
D) One channel per stakeholder + engage early

✅ Answer 4 — B

Match form to power + bidirectional asks.

Engaging early and deliberately is table stakes. Matching form to power and naming both-direction asks is the senior move.

❓ Question 5

Which quadrant do most rookie TPMs over-invest attention in — because those stakeholders are easy to engage and ask for time?

A) High power, high interest
B) High power, low interest
C) Low power, high interest
D) Low power, low interest

✅ Answer 5 — C

Low power, high interest.

They're comfortable to engage and they ask for your time — but the attention isn't strategic. Use group channels here.

❓ Question 6

"Match form to power" says a high-power, low-interest stakeholder should get:

A) A crisp written update under ~250 words
B) A weekly 30-minute sync
C) A group email digest with the wider audience
D) A quarterly newsletter

✅ Answer 6 — A

A crisp written update under ~250 words.

High-power gets crisp writing; high-interest gets conversation. Respect their time and their veto.

❓ Question 7

"Translating" a technical trade-off for a stakeholder primarily means:

A) Using simpler, less technical words
B) Re-framing it in the stakeholder's currency
C) Removing the cost so it sounds positive
D) Adding architectural detail so they trust you

✅ Answer 7 — B

Re-frame it in the stakeholder's currency.

CFO → cost. Customer Success → customer outcome. Compliance → regulatory exposure. Eng Director → velocity. "Use simpler words" misses the point.

❓ Question 8 — True / False

When predicting the stakeholder's top 5 questions for your 1-page brief, having all 5 come out friendly means the brief is well-prepared.

❌ Answer 8 — False

At least one predicted question should be **hostile.**

If all five are friendly, you're not stress-testing the brief — you're rehearsing applause.

❓ Question 9

In the objection-map template, "the line we hold" should be:

A) A general promise like "we'd compromise if needed"
B) The smallest specific ground you'd give up if the objection wins
C) The list of everything you refuse to change
D) The AI's recommended response

✅ Answer 9 — B

The smallest, specific ground you'd give up if the objection wins.

It's the senior-author signal — specific, not "we'd compromise." Vague here means pushed-around tomorrow.

❓ Question 10 — True / False

AI is a reliable source for telling you what's already been decided about your product — so you can skip validating its prior-context summary.

❌ Answer 10 — False

AI does that **poorly.**

It can re-organize what you give it — it can't tell you what's been decided or verify facts against production. Every output gets validated.

❓ Question 11

The negotiation "trade space" is the set of axes, at least one of which must move. If nothing can move, then:

A) You have maximum leverage
B) You're not negotiating — you're just saying yes or no
C) You should add more non-negotiables
D) You've automatically found the trade space

✅ Answer 11 — B

You're not negotiating — you're saying yes or no.

The trade space is scope / time / quality-resources. Offer movement on a different axis than the one they care most about.

❓ Question 12 — True / False

In the live negotiation rubric, "Held the line where it mattered" is the single highest-weighted dimension.

❌ Answer 12 — False

"Held the line" is **15%.**

"Listened first," "Translated tech to business," and "Found the trade space" each carry **20%.** Listening and translating outweigh holding the line.

🎉 That's Week 6

Score yourself — but the real check is whether you can *use* these in Monday's Week 7 delivery planning.